

HOSTFLOW

Contract Checklist

Clause-by-clause, before you sign

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Cohosting contract clause-by-clause checklist

Before you sign a cohost contract, walk every clause of the draft against this checklist. Use it with the contract template in Module 03 of the Cohosting Startup Kit, or with any contract you negotiate from scratch.

The eight clauses that must be present

Tick each clause as you verify it appears and is acceptable.

- 1. Scope of services — listing management, guest comms, pricing, cleaning coord, maintenance triage, monthly statements. Be specific.
 - 2. Term and termination — minimum 6 months, 30-day notice after minimum, mutual termination for cause with "cause" defined.
 - 3. Compensation — model + payment terms + late-fee.
 - 4. Owner obligations — property condition, photo accuracy, furnishing minimums, parking, access, city registration, license, taxes.
 - 5. Expense pass-through — what's in the fee vs. pass-through, with line items.
 - 6. Cleaning standards — checklist attached, turnover / deep / maintenance defined, who verifies.
 - 7. Liability and insurance — owner carries STR landlord insurance, you carry GL or E&O;., damage procedure defined.
 - 8. Confidentiality and non-circumvention — both directions, mutual non-disparagement.
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The three clauses you negotiate hard

TERM LENGTH. If you accept a 1-month minimum, you have no incentive to invest in a property you might lose. Six months is the floor. 12 months gives you leverage to renegotiate pricing after proving yourself.

OWNER OBLIGATIONS. If the city shows up and the property is unlicensed, that is the owner's problem, not yours. Make this clause explicit, with city registration number and license number as exhibits.

INSURANCE. If a guest is hurt and the owner is uninsured, you are exposed even when you did nothing wrong. Never start work without seeing the owner's STR insurance certificate. STR-specific, not regular homeowner.

The questions to ask before you sign

- Has the owner worked with a cohost before? If yes, why did it end?
- Is the owner planning to sell or refinance within the contract term?

- What is the property's current licensing status with the city?
 - Are taxes filed? Who pays them currently?
 - Is there a mortgage that requires landlord approval for short-term rental use?
 - Who pays for utilities, internet, smart-lock batteries, consumables?
 - Who handles the security deposit? Who refunds it?
 - Is there a vendor (cleaner, handyman) the owner wants to keep?
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Red flags in a contract draft

No defined "cause" for termination = easy kick-out by the owner at any moment.

No late-payment fee = you are financing the owner's cash flow.

No cleaning standard attached = arguments every turnover.

No owner-obligations clause = everything becomes your problem.

No insurance clause = massive personal exposure.

The full contract template

The 18-clause contract template this checklist protects is in Module 03 of the Cohosting Startup Kit. The Kit covers clauses you did not know you needed: platform-of-record (Airbnb vs. VRBO), channel sync responsibility, owner non-solicitation of your cleaners, and the offline-resolution clause for guest disputes.

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